Cotton Crop Management and Pest Control Guide

Cotton (Gossypium) is an essential commercial cash crop globally.

Common Cotton Pests:

1. American Bollworm (Helicoverpa armigera): Causes severe damage to bolls and squares.
   Management: Install pheromone traps (5 traps per hectare) and spray Bacillus thuringiensis (Bt).
2. Aphids and Whiteflies: Sap-sucking insects that cause leaf curling and transmit viruses.
   Management: Spray neem oil (5 ml per liter) or apply imidacloprid in severe infestations.
3. Pink Bollworm: Bores into flower buds and mature bolls.
   Management: Adopt crop rotation and destroy crop residues post-harvest.

Irrigation and Fertilizer:

Cotton requires 700 to 1200 mm of water throughout the growing season.

Avoid waterlogging during flowering and boll formation stages.